Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, March 24, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier – exited at 1:59 p.m.
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the following minutes of previous Council meetings be adopted:

- Regular Meeting of February 18, 2025;
- Special Meeting of February 24, 2025; and
- Closed Meeting of February 24, 2025.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Questions from the March 17, 2025 General Government Committee Meeting (Agenda item 7.2)

Douglas Glass, Ajax Resident, delivered a presentation related to agenda item 7.2, 'General Government Committee Report, March 17, 2025'.

Motion to Extend Time for Delegation

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the time allotted for the delegation on 'Questions from the March 17, 2025 General Government Committee Meeting (Agenda item 7.2)' be extended by two minutes.

CARRIED

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. D. Glass responded to questions from Council Members.

Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from the delegate.

5.2 **Delegation: Rossland Road Widening and Longo's Plaza**

Marwan Zahra, Development Manager, Belmont Equity Partners, was present to answer questions related to the Rossland Road Widening and Longo's Plaza.

With the consent of Members present, item 9.1 was advanced in the order business.

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 **Acceleration of the Rossland Road Widening**
Referred to March 24, 2025 Council meeting from February 18, 2025 Council

Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. M. Zahra, Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure & Asset Management, D. Valentim, and Mayor Collier, responded to questions from Council Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS Rossland Road has experienced a dramatic and sustained increase in traffic volume due to rapid and ongoing urban development both within the Region and specifically in Ajax;

AND WHEREAS the design for the widening and urbanization of Rossland Road, extending from Westney Road to Lakeridge Road in Ajax, is currently in progress to address these growing transportation demands;

AND WHEREAS the construction of the road improvements for the subject project is scheduled in phases, with Phase 1 planned for the section from Salem Road to Lakeridge Road in 2026, and Phase 2 from Westney Road to Salem Road in 2028;

AND WHEREAS there are several proposed developments between Harwood Avenue and Salem Road which will further exacerbate traffic congestion in the area;

AND WHEREAS the owners of the Longo's Plaza will be funding a traffic study of the area road network, to be completed by Lea Consulting, taking into consideration future development, and will be sharing the findings of the study with Town staff for consideration;

AND WHEREAS expanding the scope of Phase 1 to include the section from Harwood Avenue to Salem Road, originally planned for Phase 2, will alleviate congestion in both the short and long-term in this rapidly growing area;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. The scope of Phase 1, including land acquisition and utility relocation work planned for 2025 and road works planned for 2026, be expanded to include the section from Harwood Avenue to Lakeridge Road; and

2. The budget for the section of the project from Harwood Avenue to Lakeridge be advanced from 2028 to 2026; and

3. The design and construction include the necessary underground works to accommodate future traffic signals at Spitty Drive.

Amendment

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed amendment. Mayor Collier and M. Zahra, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

1. The scope of Phase 1 (Salem Road to Lake Ridge Road), including land acquisition and utility relocation work planned for 2025 and road works planned for 2026, be expanded to include all works associated with Phase 2 (Westney Road to Salem Road); and

2. That Council request that the Mayor identify all works as a single project in the 2026 Capital Budget; and

3. The design and construction include the necessary underground works to accommodate future traffic signals at Spitty Drive.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS Rossland Road has experienced a dramatic and sustained increase in traffic volume due to rapid and ongoing urban development both within the Region and specifically in Ajax;

AND WHEREAS the design for the widening and urbanization of Rossland Road, extending from Westney Road to Lakeridge Road in Ajax, is currently in progress to address these growing transportation demands;

AND WHEREAS the construction of the road improvements for the subject project is scheduled in phases, with Phase 1 planned for the section from Salem Road to Lakeridge Road in 2026, and Phase 2 from Westney Road to Salem Road in 2028;

AND WHEREAS there are several proposed developments between Harwood Avenue and Salem Road which will further exacerbate traffic congestion in the area;

AND WHEREAS the owners of the Longo's Plaza will be funding a traffic study of the area road network, to be completed by Lea Consulting, taking into consideration future development, and will be sharing the findings of the study with Town staff for consideration;

AND WHEREAS expanding the scope of Phase 1 to include the section from Harwood Avenue to Salem Road, originally planned for Phase 2, will alleviate congestion in both the short and long-term in this rapidly growing area;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. The scope of Phase 1 (Salem Road to Lake Ridge Road), including land acquisition and utility relocation work planned for 2025 and road works planned for 2026, be expanded to include all works associated with Phase 2 (Westney Road to Salem Road); and

2. That Council request that the Mayor identify all works as a single project in the 2026 Capital Budget; and

3. The design and construction include the necessary underground works to accommodate future traffic signals at Spitty Drive.

CARRIED

Recorded Vote

In Favour: Councillor Bower, Regional Councillor Crawford, Regional Councillor Dies, Councillor Henry, Councillor Tyler Morin, Mayor Collier

Opposed: Regional Councillor Lee

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.3 **Presentation: Business Supports and Engagement Strategy**

Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, delivered a presentation related to the Business Supports and Engagement Strategy.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. K. Brownridge responded to questions from Council Members.

Council recessed at 1:59 p.m.

Council resumed at 2:34 p.m.

Deputy Mayor Lee assumed the Chair.

With the consent of Members present, item 13.1 was advanced in the order business.

Closed Session (2:35 p.m.)

13. Authority to Hold a Closed Meeting and Related In-Camera Session

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That Council convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended:

- To discuss a matter pertaining to a trade secret or scientific, technical, commercial, financial or labour relations information, supplied in confidence to the municipality or local board, which, if disclosed, could reasonably be expected to prejudice significantly the competitive position or interfere significantly with the contractual or other negotiations of a person, group of persons, or organization negotiations [Sec. 239 (2) (i), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended]; and

- To discuss advice that is subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose [Sec. 239 (2) (f), Municipal Act, 2001, as amended].

CARRIED

13.1 **Update from Elexicon Corporation Chair**

Open Meeting (4:21 p.m.)

5.4 **Presentation: Procurement Update – Tariffs**

Michelle Trudel, Manager of Procurement, delivered a presentation related to Procurement Update – Tariffs.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. M. Trudel, D. Valentim, and K. Brownridge, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

1. That the Town of Ajax's Procurement By-Law be amended to enable staff more flexibility in choosing Canadian suppliers by aligning purchasing thresholds with the Canadian Free Trade Agreement (CFTA) and the Canada-European Union Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) (as amended).

2. That Procurement staff be directed to report back to Council, or the appropriate committee of council, regarding any major trends or policy changes that may affect procurement for local governments.

CARRIED

6. Correspondence

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the report dated March 24, 2025 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, March 3, 2025

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated March 3, 2025 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

7.2.1 General Government Committee, March 17, 2025

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the General Government Committee Report dated March 17, 2025, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Summary of Advisory Committee Activities dated March 24, 2025 as attached to the meeting agenda be received for information, and that the recommendations contained therein be referred to staff where applicable.

CARRIED

7.4 Departmental Reports

None.

8. Regional Councillors' Report

None.

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.2 Expansion of the Waterfront Parking Permit System

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Dies introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

WHEREAS the Town's Waterfront Parking Plan is enforced from May 15 to September 15 to manage increased parking on weekends and public holidays at the Ajax waterfront;

AND WHEREAS feeder streets along Lake Driveway East and West have parking restrictions enforced as part of the Waterfront Parking Plan;

AND WHEREAS Occasional Use Parking Permits are not permitted within the dates and times of the restricted waterfront permit parking areas;

AND WHEREAS each household within the parking-controlled area receives 10 free Waterfront Resident Guest Parking Permits;

AND WHEREAS there are no options available for residents to access additional permits;

AND WHEREAS Ajax residents who live along these feeder streets have expressed to their Ward Councillors that their parking needs are changing, and they would like more parking opportunities for visiting friends and family;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

By-law staff be directed to increase the number of Waterfront Resident Guest Parking permits available through the Waterfront Parking Plan to provide 15 free guest parking permits per season, per household, effective immediately and update all associated internal and public documents associated with the program.

CARRIED

9.3 Exploring a Rental Renovation Licence By-law to Address Renovictions

Regional Councillor Lee and Councillor Bower introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Regional Councillor Lee responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

WHEREAS municipalities across Ontario are experiencing a housing crisis and an affordability crisis concurrently, resulting in fewer housing options for individuals and families;

AND WHEREAS rising rental rates have resulted in a rise in the unscrupulous practice of renovictions, where landlords initiate evictions under the guise of major renovations or improvements to rental properties to remove long-time tenants paying below market rent levels and ultimately increase the rate;

AND WHEREAS to discourage the practice of renovictions, several municipalities, including the City of Hamilton and the City of Toronto have implemented Renovictions By-laws which require a landlord to apply for a licence prior to undertaking a renovation of the rental unit in cases where an eviction notice is being issued;

AND WHEREAS prior to undertaking a renovation of a residential rental unit, such Residential Rental Renovation Licences require landlords to first comply with certain standards including but not limited to providing:

- proof of a valid building permit;
- a report from a qualified person (e.g. engineer) that states that vacating the rental unit is required to complete the renovation;
- tenant accommodation or compensation plan and payment of moving allowances to support tenants;
- tenants' rights information to all tenants impacted;

AND WHEREAS in Durham Region, the Town of Whitby and City of Oshawa are exploring similar Renoviction By-laws;

AND WHEREAS it is of urgent public interest for the Town of Ajax to explore implementing stronger safeguards to protect tenants from renoviction abuse;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

Corporate Services & Planning & Development Services be directed to:

1. Investigate the feasibility, benefits, and cost of adopting a rental unit renovation by-law that would require landlords who issue an eviction notice to a tenant to demolish, repair or renovate a unit to apply to the Town within a defined timeframe for a renovation licence prior to starting any work; and

2. Bring a report and proposed by-law forward to Council or the appropriate standing committee by end of October.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-law numbers 20-2025 to 24-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

Regional Councillor Lee provided notice that he will be bringing forward a motion to the April meeting of Council related to the valuation of Town assets for naming rights.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

14. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: M. Crawford

That By-law number 25-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on March 24, 2025, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

15. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the March 24, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (4:55 p.m.)

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk